

GLOSSARY

Amphitheater

An open-air building for shows.

Amphora

A storage pot for wine or oil.

Aqueduct

A bridge for carrying water.

Arena

The floor area of an amphitheater.

Arena means "sand" in Latin.

Atrium

The entrance area of a Roman house.

Auxiliary

A soldier from a Roman province.

Ballista

A stone-throwing catapult.

Barbarian

According to the Romans, any person from outside the Roman world.

Basilica

A large public building housing law courts, offices, and shops.

Bestiarius

A performer who tormented animals in the arena.

Bulla

A lucky charm worn by children.

Calculator

A teacher who taught math.

Centurion

The commander of a century.

Century

A company of 80–100 soldiers.

Circus

A race track.

Citizen

Originally a man born in Rome to Roman parents. Eventually, people across the empire were granted the right to call themselves citizens.

Clavi

The stripes on Roman clothes.

Cohort

A unit of 480 soldiers in a legion.

Consul

The most senior government official.

Crucifixion

A form of execution in which a person was nailed or tied to a cross or tree.

Domus

A house in a town.

Editor

A wealthy person who sponsored a gladiatorial show.

Emperor

The ruler of the Roman world.

Empire

(1) The extent of all the provinces ruled by the Romans. (2) The time when Rome was ruled by emperors.

Etruscans

People in Italy, north of Rome, who flourished before the Romans.

Forum

The square in the middle of a Roman town, which was used for markets, politics, and processions.

Genius

A protecting spirit.

Gladiator

A highly trained fighter, named after the *gladius*, a type of sword.

Gladius

A short sword used by a gladiator.

Graffiti

Words scratched or painted onto a wall or other surface.

Grammaticus

A teacher who taught grammar.

Greave

A metal protector for the lower leg.

Lanista

An owner-trainer of gladiators.